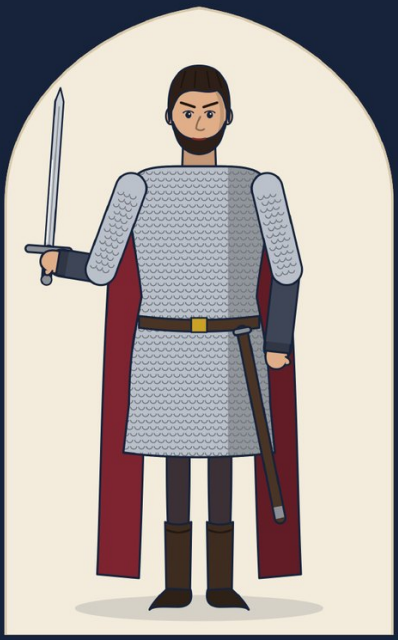
Janjua's ENGLISH LIT NOTES



Macbeth

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

EXAM EDITION

TEXT · MODERN ENGLISH · MODEL ANSWERS

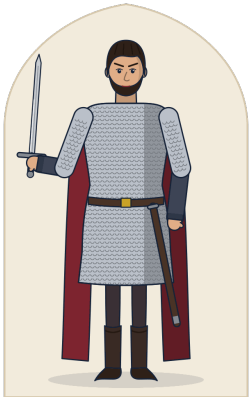
BY QAISAR IQBAL JANJUA

Janjua's ENGLISH LIT NOTES

Macbeth

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

EXAM EDITION



Every line with modern English · every scene · model answers

BY QAISAR IQBAL JANJUA

A Note from the Author

Dear student,

If you have opened this book, you probably have an exam coming, and a short play that moves at great speed. Macbeth can feel dark and strange at first: witches and riddles, old words, and one murder after another before you have caught your breath. None of it needs to frighten you. You need to know what is happening, why the characters act as they do, and how to write about it well.

That is what this book is for. Every line of the play has its meaning in plain modern English printed with it, so you always know what is being said. After each scene you will find the answers examiners look for, written the way a good answer should be written: clear, to the point, and the right length for the marks.

You do not need to read it from cover to cover. Begin with Questions That Come, find the question that worries you most, and go straight to it. In your last week, stay with Practice and Revise.

I have checked every line and every answer, and I have tried my best to keep this book free of errors. If you do find one, please tell me at qaisar@janjuaslitnotes.com, and I will put it right.

Study well, and walk into that exam with confidence. I am cheering for you.

Qaisar Iqbal Janjua

JANJUA'S ENGLISH LIT NOTES

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The Dagger and the Murder of Duncan

ACT 2, SCENES 1 AND 2 · MACBETH'S CASTLE

After midnight Macbeth sees a dagger in the air. He kills Duncan; his wife returns the daggers he dares not take back.

Unit 5 · Act 2, Scenes 1 and 2 (64 and 74 lines) · A murder off stage · Essays 1, 3, 4, 7, 10, 12

Macbeth, drawn for this book from the play.

1. Macbeth sees "A dagger of the mind, a false creation" (2.1.38). SUPERNATURAL GUILT
2. After the murder he cannot pray: "'Amen' / Stuck in my throat" (2.2.32-33). GUILT
3. Lady Macbeth smears the grooms with blood, "For it must seem their guilt" (2.2.57). VIOLENCE SEEMING

EXAMINERS ASK

Critically analyse Macbeth's dagger soliloquy. **Answer: Critical note, page 110**

How do Macbeth and Lady Macbeth react differently to the murder of Duncan? **Answer: Short answer 2, page 112**

Explain lines 33 to 39 of Act 2, Scene 1 with reference to the context. **Answer: Context answer, page 113**

✓ **A vision leads Macbeth to the deed; the deed murders his sleep.**

In this unit: **Text 96** · **Critical note 110** · **Short answers 111** · **Context answer 113** · **Objective questions 114**

CONTEXT

A murder borrowed from another story. Shakespeare's Duncan is murdered in his bed. The Cambridge editors, W. G. Clark and W. A. Wright, later edited Macbeth on its own (Clarendon Press, 1869). There they point out that the details of this murder are borrowed from a different crime in Holinshed's Chronicles: the murder of King Duff by Donwald. Shakespeare then hides the deed. It happens off stage, while Lady Macbeth waits and listens (2.2.1-13), and we see only the bloody hands and daggers afterwards. So the play shows us not the killing, but what it does to the killers.

The text

Banquo's unrest and the dagger soliloquy

ACT 2, SCENE 1 · LINES 1 TO 64

Inverness. Court of Macbeth's Castle.

Enter BANQUO, and FLEANCE bearing a torch before him.

BANQUO

How goes the night, boy?
How far into the night is it, boy?

FLEANCE

The moon is down; I have not heard the clock.
The moon has set; I have not heard the clock.

BANQUO

And she goes down at twelve.
And it sets at twelve.

FLEANCE

I take't, 'tis later, sir.
I think it is later, sir.

BANQUO

Hold, take my sword. There's husbandry in heaven,
Here, take my sword. They are saving money in heaven,

Their candles are all out. Take thee that too.
Their candles are all out. Take that too.

A heavy summons lies like lead upon me,
A heavy call to sleep lies like lead on me,

And yet I would not sleep. Merciful powers,
And yet I do not want to sleep. Merciful powers,

Restrain in me the cursed thoughts that nature
Hold back in me the cursed thoughts that nature

Gives way to in repose!
Gives way to in sleep!

Enter MACBETH, and a Servant with a torch.

BANQUO

Give me my sword.
Give me my sword.

Who's there?
Who is there?

MACBETH

A friend.
A friend.

BANQUO

What, sir, not yet at rest? The king's a-bed:
What, sir, not in bed yet? The king is in bed:

He hath been in unusual pleasure, and
He has been in unusually good spirits, and

Sent forth great largess to your offices:
Sent generous gifts to your servants' quarters:

This diamond he greets your wife withal,
With this diamond he greets your wife,

16 By the name of most kind hostess; and shut up
Calling her the kindest hostess; and he has ended the day

17 In measureless content.
In boundless contentment.

MACBETH

Being unprepared,
Because we were unprepared,

18 Our will became the servant to defect,
Our goodwill was held back by what we lacked,

19 Which else should free have wrought.
Which otherwise would have worked freely.

BANQUO

All's well.
All is well.

20 I dreamt last night of the three weird sisters:
I dreamed last night of the three weird sisters:

21 To you they have show'd some truth.
To you they have shown some truth.

MACBETH

I think not of them:
I do not think about them:

22 Yet, when we can entreat an hour to serve,
Yet, when we can find an hour that suits us,

23 We would spend it in some words upon that business,
We could spend it in a few words about that business,

24 If you would grant the time.
If you would give me the time.

BANQUO

At your kind'st leisure.
Whenever it suits you best.

WORDS
5 candles: **the stars**

MACBETH

25 If you shall cleave to my consent, when 'tis
If you will side with me, when the time comes,

26 It shall make honour for you.
It shall bring you honour.

BANQUO

So I lose none
As long as I lose none

27 In seeking to augment it, but still keep
In trying to increase it, but always keep

28 My bosom franchised and allegiance clear,
My heart free from guilt and my loyalty spotless,

29 I shall be counsell'd.
I will listen to your advice.

MACBETH

Good repose the while!
Rest well in the meantime!

BANQUO

Thanks, sir: the like to you!
Thank you, sir: the same to you!

Exeunt Banquo and Fleance.

MACBETH

Go bid thy mistress, when my drink is ready,
Go and tell your mistress, when my drink is ready,

She strike upon the bell. Get thee to bed.
To strike the bell. Go to bed.

Exit Servant.

Is this a dagger which I see before me,
Is this a dagger that I see before me,

The handle toward my hand? Come, let me clutch thee.
The handle towards my hand? Come, let me grasp you.

I have thee not, and yet I see thee still.
I do not have you, and yet I see you still.

Art thou not, fatal vision, sensible
Are you not, deadly vision, as real

To feeling as to sight? or art thou but
To touch as to sight? Or are you only

A dagger of the mind, a false creation,
A dagger of the mind, a false creation,

Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain?
Coming from an overheated brain?

I see thee yet, in form as palpable
I see you still, in a shape as solid

As this which now I draw.
As this one which I now draw.

Thou marshall'st me the way that I was going;
You lead me the way that I was going;

And such an instrument I was to use.
And just such a weapon I was going to use.

Mine eyes are made the fools o' the other senses,
My eyes are made fools of by my other senses,

Or else worth all the rest: I see thee still;
Or else they are worth all the rest: I see you still;

And on thy blade and dudgeon gouts of blood,
And on your blade and handle drops of blood,

Which was not so before. There's no such thing:
Which were not there before. There is no such thing:

It is the bloody business which informs
It is the bloody business that takes shape

Thus to mine eyes. Now o'er the one half-world
Like this before my eyes. Now over one half of the world

Nature seems dead, and wicked dreams abuse
Nature seems dead, and wicked dreams deceive

The curtain'd sleep; witchcraft celebrates
The sleeper behind his curtains; witchcraft performs

Pale Hecate's offerings; and wither'd murder,
Its offerings to pale Hecate; and withered murder,

Alarum'd by his sentinel, the wolf,
Called to action by his sentry, the wolf,

Whose howl's his watch, thus with his stealthy pace,
Whose howl is his watchword, like this, with his stealthy pace,

With Tarquin's ravishing strides, towards his design
With the strides of Tarquin going to rape, towards his goal

Moves like a ghost. Thou sure and firm-set earth,
Moves like a ghost. You sure and firmly set earth,

Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear
Do not hear my steps, or which way they walk, for fear

Thy very stones prate of my whereabout,
Your very stones chatter about where I am,

59 And take the present horror from the time,
And take away the present horror from this hour,

60 Which now suits with it. Whiles I threat, he lives:
Which suits it so well now. While I make threats, he lives:

61 Words to the heat of deeds too cold breath gives.
Words give too cold a breath to the heat of deeds.

A bell rings.

62 I go, and it is done: the bell invites me.
I go, and it is done: the bell invites me.

63 Hear it not, Duncan, for it is a knell
Do not hear it, Duncan, for it is a death bell

64 That summons thee to heaven, or to hell.
That calls you to heaven, or to hell.

Exit.

WORDS

25 cleave to my consent: **Macbeth's words are deliberately vague** · **52** Hecate: **goddess of witchcraft and the moon** · **55** Tarquin: **Roman prince who raped Lucrece at night**

The murder and the knocking

ACT 2, SCENE 2 · LINES 1 TO 74

THE SAME.

Enter LADY MACBETH.

LADY MACBETH

1 That which hath made them drunk hath made me bold;
What has made them drunk has made me bold;

2 What hath quench'd them hath given me fire. Hark! Peace!
What has put out their fire has given me fire. Listen! Quiet!

3 It was the owl that shriek'd, the fatal bellman,
It was the owl that shrieked, the deadly bellman,

Which gives the stern'st good-night. He is about it:
Who gives the grimmest goodnight. He is doing it now:

The doors are open, and the surfeited grooms
The doors are open, and the over-full servants

Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg'd their possets,
Make a mockery of their duty with snores: I have drugged their bedtime drinks,

That death and nature do contend about them,
So that death and life are fighting over them,

Whether they live or die.
Whether they live or die.

MACBETH

Within

Who's there? what, ho!
Who is there? You there!

LADY MACBETH

Alack, I am afraid they have awaked
Oh no, I am afraid they have woken up

And 'tis not done: the attempt and not the deed
And it is not done: the attempt, and not the deed,

Confounds us. Hark! I laid their daggers ready;
Ruins us. Listen! I laid their daggers ready;

He could not miss 'em. Had he not resembled
He could not miss them. If he had not looked like

My father as he slept, I had done 't.
My father as he slept, I would have done it.

Enter MACBETH.

LADY MACBETH

My husband!
My husband!

MACBETH

14 I have done the deed. Didst thou not hear a noise?
I have done the deed. Did you not hear a noise?

WORDS

3 fatal bellman: **man ringing a bell before an execution**

LADY MACBETH

15 I heard the owl scream and the crickets cry.
I heard the owl scream and the crickets cry.

16 Did not you speak?
Did you not speak?

MACBETH

When?
When?

LADY MACBETH

Now.
Now.

MACBETH

As I descended?
As I came down?

LADY MACBETH

17 Ay.
Yes.

MACBETH

18 Hark!
Listen!

19 Who lies i' the second chamber?
Who is sleeping in the second bedroom?

LADY MACBETH

Donalbain.
Donalbain.

MACBETH

Looking on his hands.

20 This is a sorry sight.
This is a miserable sight.

LADY MACBETH

21 A foolish thought, to say a sorry sight.
A foolish thought, to say a miserable sight.

MACBETH

22 There's one did laugh in's sleep, and one cried 'Murder!'
One of them laughed in his sleep, and one cried 'Murder!'

23 That they did wake each other: I stood and heard them:
So that they woke each other: I stood and listened to them:

24 But they did say their prayers, and address'd them
But they said their prayers, and settled themselves

25 Again to sleep.
Back to sleep.

LADY MACBETH

There are two lodged together.
There are two sleeping in the same room.

MACBETH

26 One cried 'God bless us!' and 'Amen' the other,
One cried 'God bless us!' and the other 'Amen',

27 As they had seen me with these hangman's hands:
As if they had seen me with these executioner's hands:

28 Listening their fear, I could not say 'Amen,'
Listening to their fear, I could not say 'Amen'

29 When they did say 'God bless us!'
When they said 'God bless us!'

LADY MACBETH

30 Consider it not so deeply.
Do not think about it so deeply.

MACBETH

But wherefore could not I pronounce 'Amen'?
But why could I not say 'Amen'?

I had most need of blessing, and 'Amen'
I had most need of a blessing, and 'Amen'

Stuck in my throat.
Stuck in my throat.

LADY MACBETH

These deeds must not be thought
These deeds must not be thought about

After these ways; so, it will make us mad.
In these ways; if they are, it will drive us mad.

MACBETH

Methought I heard a voice cry 'Sleep no more!
I thought I heard a voice cry, 'Sleep no more!

Macbeth does murder sleep'—the innocent sleep,
Macbeth is murdering sleep'—the innocent sleep,

Sleep that knits up the ravell'd sleave of care,
Sleep that knits up the tangled thread of worry,

The death of each day's life, sore labour's bath,
The death of each day's life, the bath after painful work,

Balm of hurt minds, great nature's second course,
Healing ointment for hurt minds, great nature's main course,

Chief nourisher in life's feast,—
The chief food at life's feast—

LADY MACBETH

What do you mean?
What do you mean?

MACBETH

Still it cried 'Sleep no more!' to all the house:
It kept crying 'Sleep no more!' to the whole house:

42 'Glamis hath murder'd sleep, and therefore Cawdor
'Glamis has murdered sleep, and therefore Cawdor

43 Shall sleep no more: Macbeth shall sleep no more.'
Shall sleep no more: Macbeth shall sleep no more.'

LADY MACBETH

44 Who was it that thus cried? Why, worthy thane,
Who was it that cried like that? Why, worthy thane,

45 You do unbend your noble strength, to think
You weaken your noble strength by thinking

46 So brainsickly of things. Go get some water,
So madly about things. Go and get some water,

47 And wash this filthy witness from your hand.
And wash this filthy evidence from your hand.

48 Why did you bring these daggers from the place?
Why did you bring these daggers from the room?

49 They must lie there: go carry them, and smear
They must lie there: go, take them back, and smear

50 The sleepy grooms with blood.
The sleeping servants with blood.

MACBETH

I'll go no more:
I will not go back:

51 I am afraid to think what I have done;
I am afraid to think what I have done;

52 Look on 't again I dare not.
I dare not look at it again.

LADY MACBETH

Infirm of purpose!
Weak-willed!

53 Give me the daggers: the sleeping and the dead
Give me the daggers: the sleeping and the dead

Are but as pictures: 'tis the eye of childhood
Are only like pictures: it is the eye of childhood

That fears a painted devil. If he do bleed,
That fears a painted devil. If he is bleeding,

I'll gild the faces of the grooms withal,
I will paint the servants' faces with it,

For it must seem their guilt.
For it must look like their guilt.

Exit. Knocking within.

MACBETH

Whence is that knocking?
Where is that knocking coming from?

How is't with me, when every noise appals me?
What is wrong with me, when every noise terrifies me?

What hands are here? ha! they pluck out mine eyes!
What hands are these? Ha! They pull out my eyes!

Will all great Neptune's ocean wash this blood
Will all great Neptune's ocean wash this blood

Clean from my hand? No; this my hand will rather
Clean from my hand? No, this hand of mine will rather

The multitudinous seas incarnadine,
Turn the countless seas blood-red,

Making the green one red.
Making the green sea all red.

Re-enter LADY MACBETH.

WORDS

56 gild: **cover with gold; pun on gilt and guilt** · **60** Neptune: **Roman god of the sea**

LADY MACBETH

My hands are of your colour, but I shame
My hands are the same colour as yours, but I would be ashamed

Knocking within

65 To wear a heart so white. I hear a knocking
To have a heart so white. I hear a knocking

66 At the south entry: retire we to our chamber:
At the south gate: let us go back to our bedroom:

67 A little water clears us of this deed:
A little water clears us of this deed:

68 How easy is it then! Your constancy
How easy it is, then! Your firmness

Knocking within

69 Hath left you unattended. Hark! more knocking:
Has deserted you. Listen! More knocking:

70 Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us
Put on your dressing gown, in case events call for us

71 And show us to be watchers: be not lost
And show that we have stayed awake: do not be lost

72 So poorly in your thoughts.
So weakly in your thoughts.

MACBETH

73 To know my deed, 'twere best not know myself.
To know what I have done, it would be best not to know myself.

Knocking within.

74 Wake Duncan with thy knocking! I would thou couldst!
Wake Duncan with your knocking! I wish you could!

Exeunt.

WORDS

65 white: **pale with fear; cowardly**

Critical note

Critically analyse Macbeth's dagger soliloquy.

Critical note · about 300 words

✓ **Answer.** Macbeth's dagger soliloquy (2.1.33-64) shows a divided mind: his imagination sees the horror of the deed clearly, yet his will carries him towards it. A soliloquy is a speech in which a character, alone on stage or unheard by others, speaks his or her thoughts aloud.

It opens with a vision: "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand?" (2.1.33-34). Is it a sign from outside, or "A dagger of the mind, a false creation" (2.1.38)? The play never decides, and no stage direction shows a dagger. The dagger also guides him: "Thou marshall'st me the way that I was going" (2.1.42). It leads him only where he has already chosen to go.

The vision grows worse. Drops of blood appear "on thy blade and dudgeon" (2.1.46), the blade and the handle. He admits: "It is the bloody business which informs / Thus to mine eyes" (2.1.48-49). The murder in his mind is shaping what he sees. A. C. Bradley, in Shakespearean Tragedy (Macmillan, 1904), says that Macbeth "has, within certain limits, the imagination of a poet".

The speech then turns to the dark world. "Nature seems dead" (2.1.50), and murder "Moves like a ghost" (2.1.56). Macbeth begs the earth, "Hear not my steps" (2.1.57). Darkness and silence wrap the crime.

Last, thought gives way to action. Macbeth knows that talk cools his purpose: "Words to the heat of deeds too cold breath gives" (2.1.61). A bell rings, and he goes. The closing

couplet, a pair of rhyming lines, tolls for Duncan like a funeral bell: “it is a knell / That summons thee to heaven, or to hell” (2.1.63-64).

Verdict: the soliloquy shows Macbeth choosing murder with open eyes; his imagination warns him, but his will no longer listens.

316 words

Short answers

What does Act 2, Scene 1 show about the character of Banquo?

5 marks · short answer

✓ **Answer.** The scene shows Banquo as a good man who feels the pull of temptation and resists it. After midnight he is tired, yet he will not sleep. He prays to be kept from “the cursed thoughts that nature / Gives way to in repose” (2.1.8-9). He admits that he has dreamt of the Witches. When Macbeth hints at a reward for his support, Banquo answers with care. He will accept honour only if he keeps “My bosom franchised and allegiance clear” (2.1.28): his heart free of guilt, and his loyalty to the King untouched. So Banquo acts as a foil to Macbeth, a character who shows up another by contrast. Both men heard the same prophecies, predictions of the future, but only Macbeth acts on them.

129 words

How do Macbeth and Lady Macbeth react differently to the murder of Duncan?

5 marks · short answer

✓ **Answer.** Macbeth is overcome by guilt and fear, while Lady Macbeth stays calm and practical. Macbeth stares at his bloody hands and says that he could not say Amen. He has carried off the daggers and will not take them back: "I am afraid to think what I have done" (2.2.51). Lady Macbeth takes control: she calls him weak, takes the daggers back and smears the grooms with blood (2.2.52-57). Their words about blood show the gap between them. He feels the whole ocean could not wash his hand clean; she says, "A little water clears us of this deed" (2.2.67). Yet her calm has a crack: Duncan asleep looked too like her father for her to kill him (2.2.12-13). In the sleepwalking scene, her own hands will not come clean (5.1.39).

141 words

COMMON MISTAKE

The mistake. Quoting the line as "Is this a dagger I see before me?", or placing the dagger after the murder. **The correction.** The text reads "Is this a dagger which I see before me" (2.1.33). Macbeth sees it alone, before the murder, and goes to Duncan only when "the bell invites me" (2.1.62). **Why it costs marks.** Examiners mark down a misquoted or misplaced passage.

What is the significance of the voice that cries "Macbeth does murder sleep" (2.2.36)?

5 marks · short answer

✓ **Answer.** The voice tells Macbeth that his punishment will fit his crime: he has killed a sleeping man, so he will lose sleep himself. In this play, sleep stands for peace of mind

and innocence. Macbeth praises it in a list of images. Sleep "knits up the ravell'd sleave of care" (2.2.37): it mends worry as a needle mends tangled thread. It heals hurt minds like a soothing ointment (2.2.39). Then the voice names all his titles: "Glamis hath murder'd sleep, and therefore Cawdor / Shall sleep no more: Macbeth shall sleep no more" (2.2.42-43). The Witches' honours now carry a curse. Soon Macbeth suffers terrible dreams every night (3.2.18-19), and Lady Macbeth will walk in her sleep. Lost sleep becomes the play's sign of a guilty mind.

134 words

Context answer

Act 2, Scene 1, lines 33 to 39

> Is this a dagger which I see before me,
> The handle toward my hand? Come, let me clutch thee.
> I have thee not, and yet I see thee still.
> Art thou not, fatal vision, sensible
> To feeling as to sight? or art thou but
> A dagger of the mind, a false creation,
> Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain? (2.1.33-39)

Reference to context · 200 to 250 words

✓ **Answer.**

Reference. These lines open the dagger soliloquy in Act 2, Scene 1 of Macbeth by William Shakespeare. A soliloquy is a speech in which a character, alone on stage or unheard by others, speaks his or her thoughts aloud. Macbeth speaks after midnight, in his castle at Inverness.

Context. Banquo has just gone to bed, troubled by dreams of "the three weird sisters" (2.1.20). Macbeth has told his servant to have Lady Macbeth "strike upon the bell" (2.1.32). When it rings, at the end of the speech, he goes to kill Duncan.

Explanation. Macbeth sees a dagger hanging in the air, its handle turned towards him as if offered. He tries to grasp it, but his hand closes on nothing. He asks whether this "fatal vision" (2.1.36), deadly and fateful, can be felt as well as seen. Or is it a false picture made by a fevered brain? Speaking to the dagger as if it could hear is apostrophe: speech addressed to an absent person or a thing. The balanced line "I have thee not, and yet I see thee still" (2.1.35) sets having against seeing.

Critical comment. The passage leaves open whether the dagger is supernatural or imagined. Either way, it shows that Macbeth's mind has already committed the murder. At the banquet Lady Macbeth will mock "the air-drawn dagger" (3.4.62).

232 words

Objective questions

Choose one answer. Keys are at the end of the book.

21. Macbeth tells his servant that Lady Macbeth should strike the bell:

(a) when his drink is ready
(b) when Duncan is asleep
(c) when Banquo has gone to bed
(d) when the grooms are drunk

22. Match the speaker with the line:
A. “The moon is down; I have not heard the clock” (2.1.2)
B. “I dreamt last night of the three weird sisters” (2.1.20)
C. “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood” (2.2.60)
D. “A little water clears us of this deed” (2.2.67)
Speakers:
1. Lady Macbeth
2. Fleance
3. Macbeth
4. Banquo

(a) A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1
(b) A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
(c) A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1
(d) A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3

23. Put these events in the order they happen:
I. Macbeth sees a dagger in the air
II. Banquo hands Macbeth Duncan’s diamond for Lady Macbeth
III. A bell rings
IV. Lady Macbeth takes the daggers back

(a) I, II, III, IV
(b) II, I, III, IV
(c) II, III, I, IV
(d) I, III, II, IV

24. Statement I: Lady Macbeth says she would have killed Duncan had he not looked like her father.
Statement II: Macbeth leaves the daggers in Duncan's chamber beside the grooms.

(a) Both statements are correct
(b) Both statements are incorrect
(c) Statement I is correct, Statement II is incorrect
(d) Statement I is incorrect, Statement II is correct

25. In "The multitudinous seas incarnadine" (2.2.62), "incarnadine" means:

(a) wash clean
(b) make calm
(c) make cold
(d) turn red

Janjua's ENGLISH LIT NOTES

This was a free sample of

Macbeth

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

EXAM EDITION

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